

Naval Aid to the Empire Has Been Merely Delayed

Hon. J. D. Hazen at a Political Picnic in British Columbia
Assures His Auditors that the Naval Plan of the Borden Government will be Carried Out—First Ministerial Statement on Subject Since Prorogation—Sir Richard McBride Declares no Part of Empire is More Loyal than British Columbia.

(Vancouver News-Advertiser, July 27.)
What was conceded on all sides to be the most successful political evening ever held in the Canadian West took place yesterday when the 40th anniversary of the Vancouver Conservative Association was held at the Grand Hotel.

The program of speeches was covered by the fact that Premier McBride and Mr. Hazen, who travelled from Victoria to Vancouver for the occasion, did not arrive until 10 o'clock, and left on the train for Victoria a few minutes after the Premier and Mr. Hazen had spoken, the vast of the distinguished statesmen being crowded so that they could get back to Victoria in time for a dinner last evening at which Mr. Hazen was to be host.

The reception given Sir Richard McBride and Mr. Hazen when they came forward to speak were flattering demonstrations of their popularity and esteem in the hearts of the vast assembly.

Mr. Hazen was forced to wait for five minutes in acknowledgment of the outburst of enthusiastic salutation which was vociferously manifested when he was called on to address the gathering.

Oration to Premier McBride.

Sir Richard McBride was received with a cheering cheer, which lasted for a long time, and with the singing of "For He's a Jolly Good Fellow."

The Premier said that he could recall with pride the emphasis attached to the fact that last year made at the same place by the speakers at the Conservative picnic from Vancouver regarding Canada's duty to itself and to the Empire in connection with naval matters and the history of the Conservative party in Canada.

He said that the sentiments expressed there had been the basis of the policy of the whole party, and that the majority of the Canadian people were in sympathy with the Conservative policy in parliament were anxious to see every measure to bring about as soon as possible that action which would be Canada's share in the Empire's greatest defense. It was what every loyal person held to be Canada's duty to the King and to the country, as well as to the Empire.

There was no subject fraught with more consequence than the question of defense. It was that every country (vital), but perhaps British Columbia more so, because of its position as the gateway to the Pacific and the other portions of the country, because we were on the seaboard. The people of the province, individually, in municipalities, and by Government were spending large sums of money on improvements and in extending business, and in extending development along legitimate lines, which required the consideration and attention from the legislature, but side by side with this, there was growing as it grew, the necessity for deeper care in the direction of the protection of our wealth. There was nothing, he said, so consequential to all of us as the question of Empire's defense.

Canada's Defense.

And in the same breath as he said Empire's defense, he said Canada's defense. The defense of the Empire meant the defense of Canada, and the portions of the Empire were made for the strength of each individual action of the Empire. What was due to the Empire was due to Canada as much as for the benefit of the whole.

A few hours before he had been privileged to call in an official way to the commander of the war cruiser New Zealand. It was a tangible evidence of the loyalty of New Zealand to the Crown and the Empire. As he looked over the splendid vessel, he thought that it was only owing to the fact of the irrefragable Canadian Senate that the Minister of the Crown, was forced to stand there before them and say that Canada had not taken the steps she had taken toward the construction of three such ships and have them in time for any emergency.

And he wished to say that the loyalty of Canada, and in these parts of Canada, particularly, was not an empty word. It was a reality, and it was a reality that was not a passing fancy, but a lasting and permanent character of a kind that does not need an emergency to bring it out in all its fullness. It was a loyalty that was in powerful in time of peace as in time of war. No section of the Empire was more impetuous than British Columbia. They knew that the tendency of imperialism was for the wealth of the world to be concentrated in the hands of a few, and that this was a danger to the peace, but as the factor that would make sooner and surer the progress of development of our commerce and our industries and the wealth of us all. (Long and loud applause.)

HON. J. D. HAZEN

Hon. J. D. Hazen was then introduced to the gathering by Mr. R. S. Pyle. He received an ovation. When he left Ottawa, he said, which was ten days ago, at the request of the Prime Minister, and whom they were all proud to have in their midst (cheers) he did not have the least idea of the great pleasure of seeing so many people as were before him that afternoon.

He really felt quite as much at home in the province of British Columbia as he did in our thousands miles away in New Brunswick. Their lives were all very much the same. He was greeted with a hearty handshake from many people he had known at home and who had come out here to help build up the province of British Columbia.

Following an appreciation of Sir Richard McBride he stated that he did not come out here to make a long speech, but to extend a greeting to the battalions New Zealand.

The visit came as the result of communication from the Governor-General, who stated that the visit had been for the negotiable illness of it.

It is the business of Canada to have been here his personal pleasure and delight to have come here to assist in the work that is being done.

There was no more positive man in bringing forward the claims of the province of British Columbia than the members who represented that province in the Federal House. He had intended coming here last year, and he would have been glad to have done so, but he had with the Premier to consult with British authorities as to what the situation could be in defense of the Empire by strengthening that navy, on which the commerce and general welfare of Canada so greatly depended.

Impressed by Province.

He was very much impressed here by the resources of the province, and even more by the good spirit and energy of the people. The great and the beauty of the land of British Columbia had also greatly impressed him.

In regard to the navy question he stated that the Government had not asked for funds, which, when received, they left in the hands of the navy, but he was not going to bring forward the question of the navy in the present session.

In 1912 Mr. Borden proceeded to England. They considered what the navy and the British Government, who gave them information on the subject, which was able to make public. They also received additional information from the British Government, which was able to make public.

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